

Ending obscenity in Bhojpuri Music

As a proud Bihari, a Hollywood actress and a global inspirational figure, I feel an urgent need to **address** a critical issue that has long **tarnished** our cultural heritage and **posed** a serious threat to women's **dignity** and safety. The growing **obscenity** in Bhojpuri music **is** not **merely** a matter of artistic expression; it is a **reflection** of deeply **ingrained patriarchal** attitudes that **devalue** women, normalise **objectification** and **perpetuate** a culture of disrespect and violence. This **degradation** of our musical tradition **has** had **far-reaching** consequences and we must take **decisive** action to restore its lost dignity. For generations, Bhojpuri music has been a **vibrant** medium of cultural expression, deeply **rooted in** our traditions and values.

It has narrated stories of love, devotion and social issues, **resonating** with the **soul** of our people. However, in recent years, this once-respected art form has been reduced to a **vehicle** for **vulgarity** and **misogyny**. The **lyrics** of many modern Bhojpuri songs **objectify** women, reduce them to **mere** objects of desire, and promote harmful **stereotypes** that **erode** their self-worth. This **rampant** objectification not only **diminishes** women's confidence but also **fosters** an environment where gender-based violence is normalised. When **music**—one of the most powerful tools of influence—**portrays** women in a **degrading** manner, it **reinforces** the **notion** that they are **inferior** and undeserving of respect. Beyond its impact on women, the obscenity in Bhojpuri music is also **corroding** the cultural **fabric** of Bihar and other Bhojpuri-speaking regions. What was once a **genre** celebrated for its poetic richness and emotional depth has now become **synonymous** with **crudeness** and disrespect. The **commercialisation** of vulgarity in Bhojpuri songs **has** not only tarnished the reputation of our music but has also created a **rift** between generations—**alienating** those who grew up **cherishing** its traditional **essence**.

The **urgency** of this issue **demand**s a comprehensive approach to restore respectability to Bhojpuri music while simultaneously ensuring women's dignity and safety. Laws must be **enforced** to **curb** the production and **dissemination** of **obscene** content in Bhojpuri music. While artistic freedom is important, it should not come at the cost of degrading an entire gender or **dismantling** cultural values. Stronger regulations should be implemented to hold singers, lyricists, producers, and distributors **accountable** for their content. The government should **establish** a monitoring body to review music content before its release, and strict penalties should be **imposed** on those who promote vulgarity in the name of entertainment. Awareness campaigns should be launched to educate them about their rights and the harmful effects of such content.

This can be achieved by promoting artists who create respectful, meaningful, and **uplifting** content. **Music labels** should be encouraged to invest in artists who uphold the **integrity** of Bhojpuri music. Awards and **incentives** should be introduced to **honour** musicians who create songs that celebrate women and cultural values. Schools and cultural institutions should integrate traditional Bhojpuri music into their curriculum to revive its authentic **charm**. Restoring dignity to Bhojpuri music requires

collective action from society. The **degradation** of Bhojpuri music into a platform for obscenity **is** an issue that affects not just women but the very soul of our cultural identity.

We must act now to **reclaim** the dignity of our music, ensure women's safety, and uphold the values that define us as a society. The **fight** against obscenity in Bhojpuri music **is** not about restricting artistic expression but about fostering a culture where art uplifts rather than degrades. It is time for us to unite and **take a stand**. Let us demand **accountability** from those who produce and promote obscene content. Let us **empower** women to challenge these harmful narratives. Let us support artists who honour our traditions and values. Above all, let us work together to build a future where Bhojpuri music is once again a source of pride, inspiration, and cultural **enrichment**. The time for change is now—let us be the voice that restores honour to Bhojpuri music and creates a world where women are valued, respected, and celebrated. Together, we can bring back the true essence of Bhojpuri music and ensure that it remains a symbol of our rich cultural **legacy** for generations to come.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'. [Practice Exercise]
- **Inferior** (adjective) – Mediocre, lesser, lower, substandard, poorer घटिया, निम्न

Vocabulary

1. **Obscenity** (noun) – Vulgarity, Indecency, Lewdness, Filth, Profanity अश्लीलता
2. **Address** (verb) – Tackle, Confront, Deal with, Handle, Approach सुलझाना, निपटाना
3. **Tarnish** (verb) – Stain, Damage, Blemish, Spoil, Sully धूमिल करना
4. **Pose** (verb) – Present, Create, Cause, Raise, Introduce खड़ा करना
5. **Dignity** (noun) – Respect, Honor, Pride, Self-respect, Nobility गरिमा
6. **Merely** (adverb) – Only, Simply, Just, Solely, Purely केवल
7. **Reflection** (noun) – Image, Mirror, Thought, Consideration, Contemplation प्रतिबिंब
8. **Ingrained** (adjective) – Deep-rooted, Inherent, Fixed, Entrenched, Ingrained गहराई से जमा हुआ
9. **Patriarchal** (adjective) – Male-dominated, Traditional, Authoritarian, Conservative, Hierarchical पितृसत्तात्मक
10. **Devalue** (verb) – Diminish, Undermine, Belittle, Degrade, Depreciate मूल्य घटाना
11. **Objectification** (noun) – Dehumanization, Commodification, Exploitation, Reduction, Stereotyping वस्तुकरण
12. **Perpetuate** (verb) – Continue, Sustain, Prolong, Maintain, Preserve कायम रखना
13. **Degradation** (noun) – Deterioration, Decline, Decay, Debasement, Corruption अवनति
14. **Far-reaching** (adjective) – Extensive, Widespread, Significant, Broad, Profound दूरगामी
15. **Decisive** (adjective) – Conclusive, Definitive, Final, Critical, Crucial निर्णायक
16. **Vibrant** (adjective) – Lively, Energetic, Dynamic, Vigorous, Spirited जीवंत
17. **Rooted** (in) (adjective) – Grounded, Established, Fixed, Firm, Deep-seated जड़ जमाए हुए
18. **Resonate** (verb) – Echo, Reverberate, Reflect, Harmonize, Connect प्रतिध्वनित होना
19. **Soul** (noun) – Spirit, Essence, Heart, Core, Being आत्मा
20. **Vehicle** (noun) – Medium, Instrument, Means, Channel, Tool माध्यम
21. **Vulgarity** (noun) – Obscenity, Crudeness, Indecency, Coarseness, Lewdness अश्लीलता

22. **Misogyny** (noun) – Sexism, Male chauvinism, Prejudice, Discrimination, Hatred स्त्रीद्वेष
23. **Mere** (adjective) – Only, Just, Simple, Bare, Pure मात्र
24. **Stereotype** (noun) – Generalization, Cliché, Preconception, Bias, Label रूढ़िवादिता
25. **Erode** (verb) – Wear away, Deteriorate, Corrode, Diminish, Undermine कम करना
26. **Rampant** (adjective) – Uncontrolled, Widespread, Unchecked, Prevalent, Rife अनियंत्रित
27. **Diminish** (verb) – Reduce, Decrease, Lessen, Weaken, Shrink कम करना
28. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, Promote, Nurture, Cultivate, Support प्रोत्साहित करना
29. **Portray** (verb) – Depict, Represent, Describe, Illustrate, Show चित्रित करना
30. **Degrading** (adjective) – Humiliating, Demeaning, Insulting, Disrespectful, Shameful अपमानजनक
31. **Reinforce** (verb) – Strengthen, Support, Bolster, Fortify, Enhance मजबूत करना
32. **Notion** (noun) – Idea, Concept, Belief, Thought, Perception धारणा
33. **Corrode** (verb) – Erode, Deteriorate, Wear away, Rust, Decay खराब करना
34. **Fabric** (noun) – Structure, Framework, Foundation, Texture, Makeup संरचना
35. **Genre** (noun) – Category, Style, Type, Form, Classification शैली
36. **Synonymous** (adjective) – Equivalent, Identical, Interchangeable, Corresponding, Parallel पर्यायवाची/ एक सा
37. **Crudeness** (noun) – Coarseness, Vulgarity, Roughness, Rudeness, Indecency असभ्यता
38. **Commercialisation** (noun) – Monetization, Exploitation, Marketing, Profit-making, Trade व्यावसायीकरण
39. **Rift** (noun) – Division, Split, Gap, Breach, Disagreement दरार
40. **Alienate** (verb) – Estrange, Isolate, Distance, Separate, Disaffect अलग करना
41. **Cherish** (verb) – Treasure, Value, Adore, Prize, Hold dear संजोना
42. **Essence** (noun) – Core, Soul, Heart, Spirit, Quintessence सार
43. **Urgency** (noun) – Importance, Necessity, Priority, Criticality, Imperativeness तात्कालिकता
44. **Enforce** (verb) – Implement, Apply, Impose, Execute, Administer लागू करना
45. **Curb** (verb) – Restrict, Control, Limit, Check, Suppress रोकना

46. **Dissemination** (noun) – Spread, Distribution, Circulation, Propagation, Diffusion प्रसार
47. **Obscene** (adjective) – Vulgar, Indecent, Lewd, Filthy, Offensive अश्लील
48. **Dismantle** (verb) – Disassemble, Deconstruct, Break down, Demolish, Destroy तोड़ना
49. **Accountable** (for) (adjective) – Responsible, Answerable, Liable, Obligated, Culpable जिम्मेदार
50. **Establish** (verb) – Set up, Create, Found, Institute, Build स्थापित करना
51. **Impose** (verb) – Enforce, Apply, Levy, Introduce, Inflict थोपना
52. **Uplifting** (adjective) – Inspiring, Encouraging, Motivating, Elevating, Positive उत्थानकारी
53. **Music label** (noun) – Record label, Production company, Music publisher, Studio, Brand संगीत लेबल
54. **Integrity** (noun) – Honesty, Morality, Virtue, Uprightness, Rectitude ईमानदारी
55. **Incentive** (noun) – Motivation, Encouragement, Stimulus, Inducement, Spur प्रोत्साहन
56. **Honour** (verb) – Respect, Celebrate, Recognize, Acknowledge, Commend सम्मानित करना
57. **Charm** (noun) – Appeal, Attraction, Allure, Enchantment, Magnetism आकर्षण
58. **Reclaim** (verb) – Recover, Retrieve, Regain, Restore, Salvage पुनः प्राप्त करना
59. **Take a stand** (phrase) – Assert, Defend, Support, Advocate, Oppose मुखर होना/ एक निर्णय लेना
60. **Accountability** (noun) – Responsibility, Answerability, Liability, Obligation, Culpability जवाबदेही
61. **Empower** (verb) – Enable, Authorize, Strengthen, Encourage, Support सशक्त करना
62. **Enrichment** (noun) – Enhancement, Improvement, Development, Augmentation, Advancement सम्पन्नीकरण
63. **Legacy** (noun) – Heritage, Tradition, Inheritance, Bequest, History विरासत

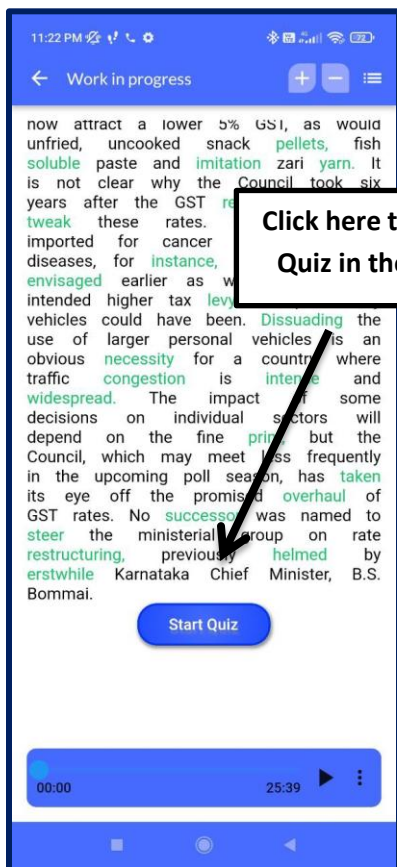
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Cultural Degradation:** The growing obscenity in Bhojpuri music is tarnishing Bihar's cultural heritage and undermining women's dignity and safety.
2. **Patriarchal Attitudes:** The vulgarity in Bhojpuri music reflects patriarchal norms that devalue women, normalize objectification, and perpetuate disrespect and violence.
3. **Historical Significance:** Bhojpuri music has traditionally been a vibrant medium of cultural expression, narrating stories of love, devotion, and social issues.
4. **Modern Vulgarity:** In recent years, Bhojpuri music has shifted from poetic richness to vulgarity and misogyny, with lyrics that objectify women and promote harmful stereotypes.
5. **Impact on Women:** The objectification in music erodes women's self-worth, diminishes their confidence, and normalizes gender-based violence.
6. **Cultural Erosion:** The commercialization of vulgarity has alienated older generations and damaged the cultural fabric of Bhojpuri-speaking regions.
7. **Need for Action:** A comprehensive approach is required to restore respectability to Bhojpuri music while safeguarding women's dignity.
8. **Legal Measures:** Stronger laws and regulations are needed to curb the production and dissemination of obscene content, holding artists, producers, and distributors accountable.
9. **Monitoring Body:** A government body should review music content before release, with strict penalties for those promoting vulgarity.
10. **Awareness Campaigns:** Public awareness initiatives should educate people about the harmful effects of obscene content and promote women's rights.
11. **Promoting Positive Art:** Encouraging artists who create respectful and meaningful content can help restore the integrity of Bhojpuri music.
12. **Incentives for Artists:** Awards and incentives should honor musicians who celebrate women and cultural values in their work.
13. **Cultural Revival:** Schools and institutions should integrate traditional Bhojpuri music into their curriculum to revive its authentic charm.
14. **Collective Responsibility:** Restoring dignity to Bhojpuri music requires collective action from society, including artists, policymakers, and the public.

15. **Empowering Women:** Women must be empowered to challenge harmful narratives and demand respect in cultural representations.
16. **Uplifting Art:** The fight against obscenity is not about restricting artistic freedom but ensuring that art uplifts and inspires rather than degrades.
17. **Call for Unity:** Society must unite to reclaim Bhojpuri music's dignity, ensuring it becomes a source of pride and cultural enrichment once again.
18. **Future Vision:** The goal is to create a world where Bhojpuri music celebrates cultural values and women are respected, valued, and celebrated.
19. **Time for Change:** Immediate action is needed to restore honor to Bhojpuri music and preserve it as a symbol of Bihar's rich cultural legacy for future generations.

@mocks_wallah

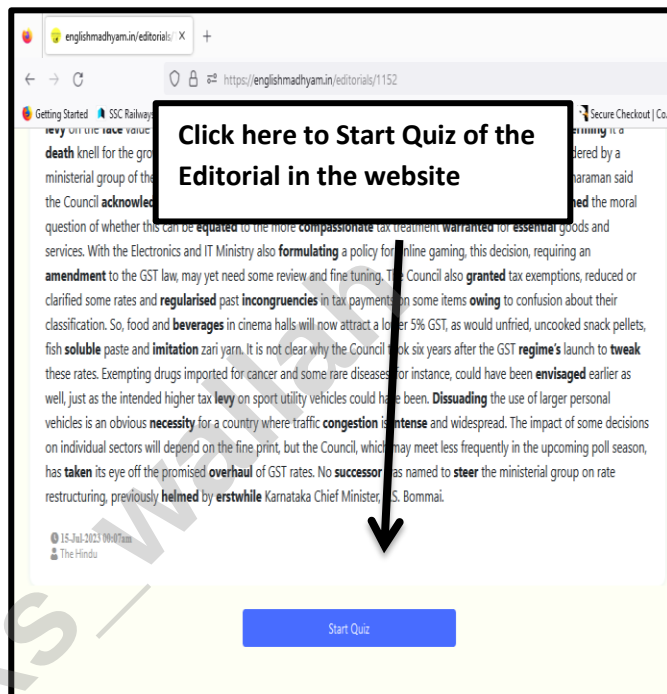
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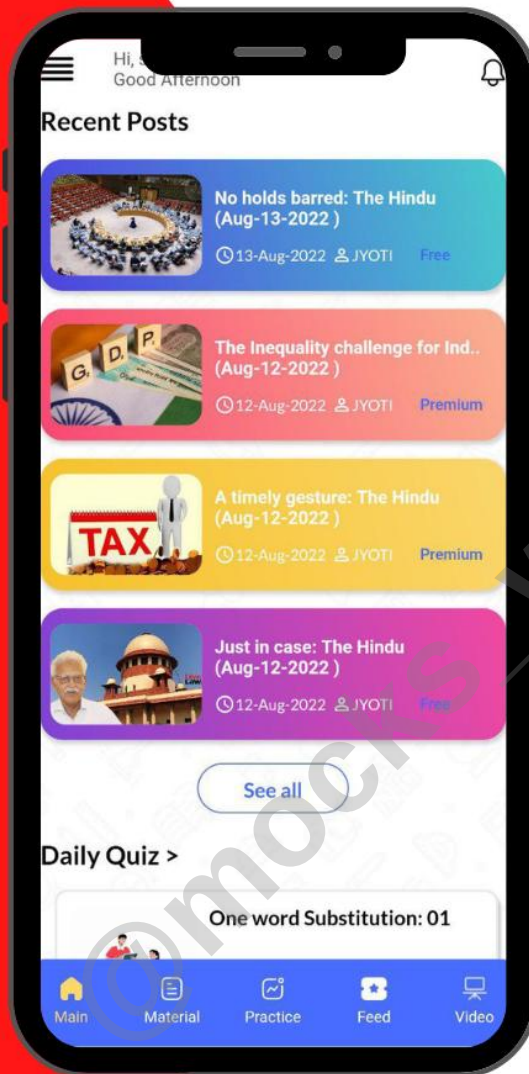
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